Juan Becerra

Software Engineer – Gameplay, Animation & Tools

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Samy Duc
EA Studios - Respawn
Electronic Arts
Los Angeles, CA / Vancouver, BC

Re: Gameplay Data Science Engineer (Apex Legends) (Role ID: 216112)

Dear Samy Duc,

I am writing to express my strong interest in the **Gameplay Data Science Engineer** position at Respawn Entertainment. Over the past five years at Electronic Arts (four years as a Gameplay & Animation Software Engineer at **Maxis** on *Project Rene* (*The Sims*) and currently at **Lifestyle**), combined with my ongoing graduate coursework in Machine Learning & Deep Learning at the University of Washington, my work has centered on C++ engine-level gameplay systems, agent navigation and behavior architectures, and Python/PyTorch machine learning pipelines. I would be thrilled to help advance intelligent bot behaviors and scalable AI frameworks for Apex Legends.

In my current role at **EA Lifestyle**, I bridge runtime engine data extraction and machine learning workflows, building a high-throughput Unreal Engine C++ plugin that captures, structures, and exports runtime character trajectory, pose, and velocity datasets to train and populate motion-matching query databases. In parallel, I prototyped and integrated ML-assisted pipelines using Python, PyTorch, and ONNX Runtime into authoring workflows for automated asset tagging and procedural pose generation, and architected cross-studio Python data-processing tools that reduced manual workflows by over 70%.

During my tenure at **EA Maxis Studios**, I focused on engine-level agent navigation, locomotion, and behavior tooling in Unreal Engine 5 and C++. I architected a multi-threaded, asynchronous path-planning and navigation API that enabled deterministic agent routing and real-time obstacle avoidance for shared multiplayer simulation. I also implemented core locomotion and runtime animation systems, including motion-matching, direct/indirect control schemes, and custom IK solvers, and partnered closely with gameplay designers to build in-editor tuning tools and visual debuggers while profiling runtime memory and compute across character evaluation graphs and spatial queries.

As an internal EA engineer based in the Pacific Northwest with a deep appreciation for Apex Legends' movement and combat depth, I am excited about the opportunity to collaborate with Respawn's team to translate creative design goals into high-performance, realistic agent behaviors. Thank you for your time and consideration, and I look forward to discussing how my experience can contribute to the team.

Sincerely,

Juan Becerra